MUHAMMAD USMAN KHAN AFRIDI (Information Security)

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AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate | CCNA | Introduction to Cyber Security (NetAcad) | CEH – In Progress

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Information Security Engineer with 3+ years of progressive experience spanning Cybersecurity, Network Infrastructure, RF Engineering, and Healthcare IT. Currently specializing in enterprise PAM deployment, SIEM administration (LogRhythm, QRadar, Logsign), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, and 24/7 SOC operations securing critical environments across government, financial, and healthcare sectors. Previously delivered network infrastructure solutions for healthcare institutions, optimized multi-technology radio networks (5G/LTE/3G/2G) for Huawei projects, and supported Hospital Management Systems across military hospital facilities. Strong expertise in threat detection, incident response, Active Directory, network security, and compliance management. AWS Certified Solutions Architect, Associate & CCNA certified. Fluent in English and Urdu.

KEY SKILLS

- **Security Operations:** SOC Operations, 24/7 Security Monitoring, Threat Detection & Response, Incident Management, Alert Triage & Escalation, Threat Hunting
- **Identity & Access Management:** Privileged Access Management (PAM), Active Directory Administration, LDAP Authentication, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Password Vaulting, Privileged Account Management, Automated Credential Rotation
- **Security Information & Event Management:** LogRhythm, IBM QRadar, Logsign, Security Use Case Design, Correlation Rules, Custom Alerts, Log Analysis, SIEM Integration, Threat Intelligence
- **Endpoint & Network Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Cisco Firepower, Cisco FMC, Firewalls, Network Monitoring, IDS/IPS, DNS Security, DLP Solutions, Malware Analysis, Vulnerability Management
- **Network Infrastructure:** VLANs, VLAN Trunking, Firewall Configuration (Huawei/Cisco), DNS/DHCP, FTP Servers, Network Monitoring, KPI Optimization, 5G/LTE/3G/2G Technologies, RF Engineering, Network Troubleshooting
- **Compliance & Risk Management:** Security Compliance, Risk Assessment, Threat Analysis, Security Policy Implementation, Audit & Verification, Organizational Security Posture Enhancement

PROFESSIONAL EXPRINCE

Information Security Engineer | Privileged Access Management (PAM) Specialist *Oct 2023 – Present*

COMMTEL, Islamabad

Enterprise PAM Implementation & Deployment

- Architected and deployed enterprise-grade Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution providing secure governance of 500+ privileged accounts across multiple organizational departments
- Integrated PAM platform with Microsoft Active Directory (AD) enabling centralized authentication, automated user synchronization, and dynamic role-based access control (RBAC) policies
- Configured privileged account onboarding workflows with 100% compliance, enabling secure password vaulting, automated credential rotation, and just-in-time (JIT) access provisioning
- Resolved complex PAM deployment challenges including Active Directory integration issues, LDAP authentication complexities, and password synchronization problems affecting system availability
- Created secure access flows enabling users to authenticate and access critical infrastructure including Routers, Switches, Firewalls, Enterprise Servers, and SIEM platforms with full audit trails
- Performed comprehensive device onboarding and PAM component configuration ensuring 99.9% system availability and seamless integration with existing enterprise IT infrastructure
- Served as primary technical liaison with enterprise customer stakeholders throughout entire project lifecycle, conducting technical workshops and presenting deployment progress during C-level meetings
- Collaborated with customer IT, Security, and Infrastructure teams to ensure zero-downtime integration and full compatibility with legacy enterprise systems

SIEM and Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR) Deployment

- Deployed and operationalized three major SIEM platforms (LogRhythm, Logsign, IBM QRadar) providing enterprise-wide security monitoring and threat detection for Ministry of Science and Technology, HEC, and ASKARI Bank
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across 1000+ endpoints delivering real-time endpoint visibility, advanced malware detection, behavioral threat analysis, and automated response capabilities
- Integrated critical log sources from Active Directory, DNS, network infrastructure (switches, routers), Cisco Firepower firewalls, and Cisco FMC into SIEM ecosystems enabling comprehensive threat correlation
- Designed 50+ security use cases with advanced correlation rules and custom alerts aligned with organizational risk profiles and regulatory compliance requirements
- Achieved 40% reduction in false positive alerts through tuning and optimization of detection rules improving SOC analyst efficiency

Security Operations Center (SOC) Analyst – Level 1

- Performed 24/7 security monitoring and threat detection operations using industry-leading SIEM platforms identifying and analyzing 200+ potential cybersecurity incidents monthly
- Conducted comprehensive investigation of security alerts identifying Indicators of Compromise (IOCs), analyzing logs from firewalls, endpoints, servers, and network devices with 99% accuracy rate
- Performed initial alert triage evaluating severity levels and escalating confirmed security incidents to SOC L2/L3 teams with complete forensic documentation
- Utilized CrowdStrike Falcon EDR to monitor endpoint activities, detect malicious processes, analyze behavioral anomalies, and enable rapid incident containment
- Monitored Cisco Firepower, Active Directory, and DNS logs detecting unauthorized access attempts, suspicious authentication patterns, and policy violations in real-time
- Assisted incident response activities including threat containment strategies, root cause analysis, post-incident documentation, and lessons learned reporting
- Maintained detailed incident tracking and reporting in ticketing systems (ServiceNow, Jira) ensuring accountability and audit compliance
- Collaborated with network operations and security teams implementing recommendations that improved overall threat detection capabilities by 35%

Network Support Engineer *Feb 2023 – Aug 2023*

Khyber Girls Medical College (KGMC) | Peshawar, Pakistan

Key Achievements:

- Administered enterprise IT infrastructure and network governance for healthcare institution serving 500+ daily users ensuring HIPAA compliance and data protection
- Designed and implemented high-availability network architecture with Active/Standby firewall failover using Huawei USG 6555E achieving 99.9% uptime
- Configured and optimized VLAN segmentation across 10+ VLANs with VLAN trunking protocols enhancing network security and performance

- Deployed DNS and DHCP servers for centralized IP address management supporting 500+ devices with automatic configuration
- Implemented FTP server infrastructure enabling secure data transfer and backup protocols across departments
- Monitored network performance metrics including availability, utilization, throughput, goodput, and latency identifying and resolving bottlenecks
- Served on technical and financial tender opening committee evaluating network infrastructure proposals and ensuring optimal procurement
- Troubleshot complex network issues and provided escalation support resolving 98% of incidents within SLA
- Successfully deployed enterprise firewall security policies protecting healthcare data from cyber threats

Radio Frequency (RF) Engineer – KPI Optimization Specialist *April 2018 – Feb 2023*

TURNOTECH (Huawei Projects) | Rawalpindi, Pakistan

Key Achievements:

Network Performance Management & KPI Optimization

- Analyzed and optimized cluster-level KPIs across 5G (NR), LTE (L700, L900, L1800, L2100, L2300 TDD), 3G, and 2G radio technologies improving network performance and customer satisfaction
- Monitored critical performance metrics including drop calls, access failures, handover failures, interference, PSC collisions, throughput, IRAT, and cell availability
- Generated and distributed daily KPI statistics reports to Front Line teams and customer stakeholders enabling data-driven network optimization decisions
- Provided 24/7 online support to Drive Test engineers on live network infrastructure (U2020 platform) enabling real-time parameter adjustments
- Executed parameter changes on live network, test sites, and neighbor sites using U2020 tools improving network performance by 30%
- Identified and troubleshot worst-performing cells reducing call drop rates by 25% through systematic optimization
- Reviewed comprehensive Post Drive Test reports validating consistency between static performance tests and mobility measurements across network
- Processed and analyzed drive test logs using GENEX Assistant generating detailed performance reports and optimization recommendations
- Standardized Site Survey Verification (SSV) reporting for 3G Dual Carrier LTE and 5G NR technologies ensuring consistent data quality
- Monitored critical KPIs including RTWP, RSSI, VSWR, CL MIMO, and CQI implementing corrective actions within 24-hour SLA
- Conducted technical meetings with Front Line teams managing Drive Test campaign progress, resolving queries, and implementing feedback
- Maintained daily campaign trackers and progress documentation ensuring transparency and stakeholder visibility

Resident Engineer – Healthcare IT Systems *July 2013 – June 2016*

Interactive Group of Companies | Combined Military Hospital (CMH) Peshawar and CMH Landikotal

Key Achievements:

- Maintained and supported Hospital Management Software (HMS) infrastructure serving 1000+ daily users across two military hospital locations
- Provided comprehensive technical training to doctors, nurses, and administrative staff ensuring efficient system utilization
- Resolved critical HMS issues and provided 24/7 technical support ensuring continuity of patient care operations
- Implemented data backup and disaster recovery procedures protecting sensitive patient health information

TECHNICAL SKILLS & PLATFORMS

- **Security Platforms:** LogRhythm, IBM QRadar, Logsign, CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Cisco Firepower, Cisco FMC, Microsoft Defender, Splunk
- **Identity & Access Management:** Microsoft Active Directory, LDAP, Kerberos, PAM Solutions, VPN Technologies, MFA Systems
- **Networking:** Huawei firewalls (USG series), Cisco ASA/ISR, VLANs, VLAN Trunking, DNS/DHCP, FTP, Network monitoring tools, U2020 platform
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC), Cloud Security Architecture, Hybrid Network Management
- **Mobile/Wireless Technologies:** 5G NR, LTE (L700, L900, L1800, L2100, L2300 TDD), 3G (UMTS), 2G (GSM), KPI Analysis, Drive Test Analysis (GENEX), Radio Network Optimization
- **Tools & Utilities:** GENEX Assistant, Ticketing Systems (ServiceNow, Jira), SIEM Management Interfaces, Endpoint Detection Consoles, Network Analysis Tools
- **Operating Systems:** Windows Server, Linux (Ubuntu), MacOS

EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

BS Telecommunications Engineering – National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences (NUCES), Pakistan (2008-2012)

REFERENCES

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